

STAGE ONE • SELF-AWARENESS & CAREER CLARITY

FIRSTS

DISCUSSION PROMPTS

Open-ended questions to seed group conversation beyond the worksheets

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Discussion Prompts

Stage One • Self-Awareness & Career Clarity

PURPOSE

Individual worksheets answer “what did you come up with?” Discussion prompts answer a different, equally important question: “what did that bring up for you, and does anyone else relate?” These are open-ended, genuinely personal questions meant to seed conversation beyond a simple share-out of worksheet answers.

Use these whenever a session's share-out portion needs more than “any volunteers?”, when a session finishes its planned agenda with time to spare, or when a group's energy has gone quiet and needs a real, specific prompt to restart it. They are organized by session, four prompts each, roughly matched to the order that session's FIRSTS are covered.

These are meant to be read aloud, not handed out on paper — pick the one or two that feel most alive for the room rather than working through all four in sequence every time.

Prompts by Session

SESSION 1

Foundations of Self

"What's a value you hold that would surprise people who only know you casually?"

"Has anyone ever taken a job or opportunity that looked great on paper but violated something they now recognize as a core value? What happened?"

"Where did your career vision come from — genuinely your own, or partly inherited from family or cultural expectation? How do you tell the difference?"

"What's a strength you have that you almost left off your list because it felt too obvious or ordinary to count?"

SESSION 2

Aligning with the Market

"What's a passion you have that you've assumed could never become a career? Is that actually true, or just untested?"

"What's the most surprising thing you learned researching your target industry today?"

"If salary were genuinely no object, would your target role change? What does that tell you about what you actually want?"

"Looking at your SWOT, which quadrant was hardest to write honestly, and why?"

SESSION 3

Working Style & Systems

"What's a work environment or team dynamic that's brought out your worst work, even though nothing was technically wrong with it?"

"Describe a decision you made quickly that turned out well, and one you rushed that you regret. What was actually different between them?"

"What's a subject or skill you were told you were 'bad at' that you now suspect was actually just taught in a format that didn't match how you learn?"

"What's one productivity system or habit you're willing to commit to trying for the next two weeks, starting today?"